

6.3 Planning

Students will be expected to plan an experiment set by Pearson, although they will not be expected to carry it out.

Candidates will be assessed on their ability to:

Plan an experiment

- identify the most appropriate apparatus, giving details. These may include the range and resolution of instruments and/or relevant dimensions of apparatus (e.g. the length of string used for a pendulum)
 - discuss calibration of instruments, e.g. whether a meter reads zero before measurements are made
 - describe how to measure relevant variables using the most appropriate instrument(s) and techniques
 - identify and state how to control all other relevant variables to make it a fair test
 - discuss whether repeat readings are appropriate
 - identify health and safety issues and discuss how these may be dealt with
 - discuss how the data collected will be used.
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